

Branding Terms

Branding is the communication of an organization's message, values and experience. Everything from a company's logo and identifiable design elements to the "gut feeling" people get about an organization driver of the why behind a website. When it comes to web design, you have the opportunity to create experiences that reinforce the company's brand.

- 1. Identity:** The entire visual representation of your brand, can include logo, color, typography, imagery, voice, etc. Not just a logo.
- 2. Lettermark/Wordmark/Logotype:** A type of logo made with stylized letters (IBM) or words (Coca-Cola)
- 3. Brandmark:** A type of Logo made with a graphical representation (Apple, Target)
- 4. Icon:** A simplified rendering of an object or concept. A logo and an icon are not the same thing.
- 5. Design System:** A repository of reusable digital components that combine to form a website.
- 6. Brand Guide:** A visual and philosophical reference for a brand's color, personality and voice.

User Experience Terms

User experience encompasses how people interact and engage with a website. User experience influences how we direct users through the site and lead them to specific end goals. It encompasses many elements of design and development including how something looks and works. Make functionality decisions with the end-user in mind, not your own preference or the tools you are using.

7. Persona: Fictional character that represents a primary user of your site/product. Usually, personas are very well-developed because they should represent real people with real motivations.

8. Wireframe: Low-fidelity layout of a site, representation of general block-level content and interactive elements.

9. Mockup: High-fidelity layout of a site, representation of final color, typography, imagery, etc.

10. Prototype: Interactive version of a site, may not be built with final code.

11. CTA: Call to action, usually paired with a button.

12. Conversion: When a user takes a specific desired action.

13. Landing Page: Single page optimized for a specific audience or search engine result.

14. Usability: How real users actually interact with your site, usually tested by observing a series of guided tasks.

User Interface Terms

User interface (also known as UX & UI) includes elements on the page with which the user interacts. Your user interface does impact your user experience, although they aren't the same thing. Don't make your users think; Design an intuitive interface that takes advantage of modern patterns.

15. Breadcrumb: Hierarchical content links.

16. Menu: Primary navigation area, sometimes with a dropdown or flyout of sub-menu items.

17. Filter: Pre-defined elements that allow narrowing down of visible content by various taxonomies (taxonomies are a fancy way of saying categories).

18. Search: Open-ended input that queries content and returns a list of results.

19. Slider: A trendy, animated way of displaying information that you probably shouldn't use.